The muted reaction of Indian Muslims to Turkey's actions can also be explained somewhat by the fact that the Caliphate movement was on the wane anyway by this time. In particular, the division between Muslim and Hindu agitators had been growing since 1921. For while the non-co-operation and Caliphate movements had collaborated in protest against the West they had never really merged into an integrated struggle. This was, in part, due to disagreements about the use of violence and the question of civil disobedience.[110] In trying to bring together two disparate movements, Gandhi had repeatedly to defend his position to both Muslim leaders and Hindu activists.[111] As early as May 1921, Reading had predicted that 'the Hindu-Moslem combination...rests upon insecure foundations'.[112] Later that year in August, a confrontation between the Indian government and Caliphate protestors in Malabar resulted in an uprising which developed into the committing of atrocities by Muslims against Hindus, including forcible conversion and murder.[113] News of the Moplah rebellion, as it became known, caused serious upset among the general Hindu population, and Gandhi had to struggle to keep the Hindu-Muslim alliance alive.[114] By January 1922 Reading was reporting how the extremist pan-Islamic language of some of the Caliphate leaders was also causing concern to more moderate Hindus.[115]

*The relative failure of the non-co-operation movement by mid-1922 caused further disenchantment among the population.[116] In November 1921 a hartal (general strike) had been called in response to the arrival of the Prince of Wales in India, and there were a number of violent outbreaks throughout the country.[117] By 4 February 1922 the movement reached a peak when a mob of around 2,000 agitators attacked government buildings in Chauri Chaura in the United Provinces, killing and mutilating the bodies of police and government officials trapped inside.[118] To those watching from London, the Indian government's hitherto lenient attitude towards Gandhi and his followers was to blame for this current crisis. In a Cabinet meeting two days later, 'General regret was expressed at the delay which had taken place in arresting Gandhi, a policy which the Cabinet had favoured more than three months ago.'[119] Feeling the pressure, Montagu was now far less supportive than he had been in 1920. Consequently the secretary of state fired off a telegram demanding those principally involved in the non-co-operation movement – including Gandhi – be promptly dealt with. As*